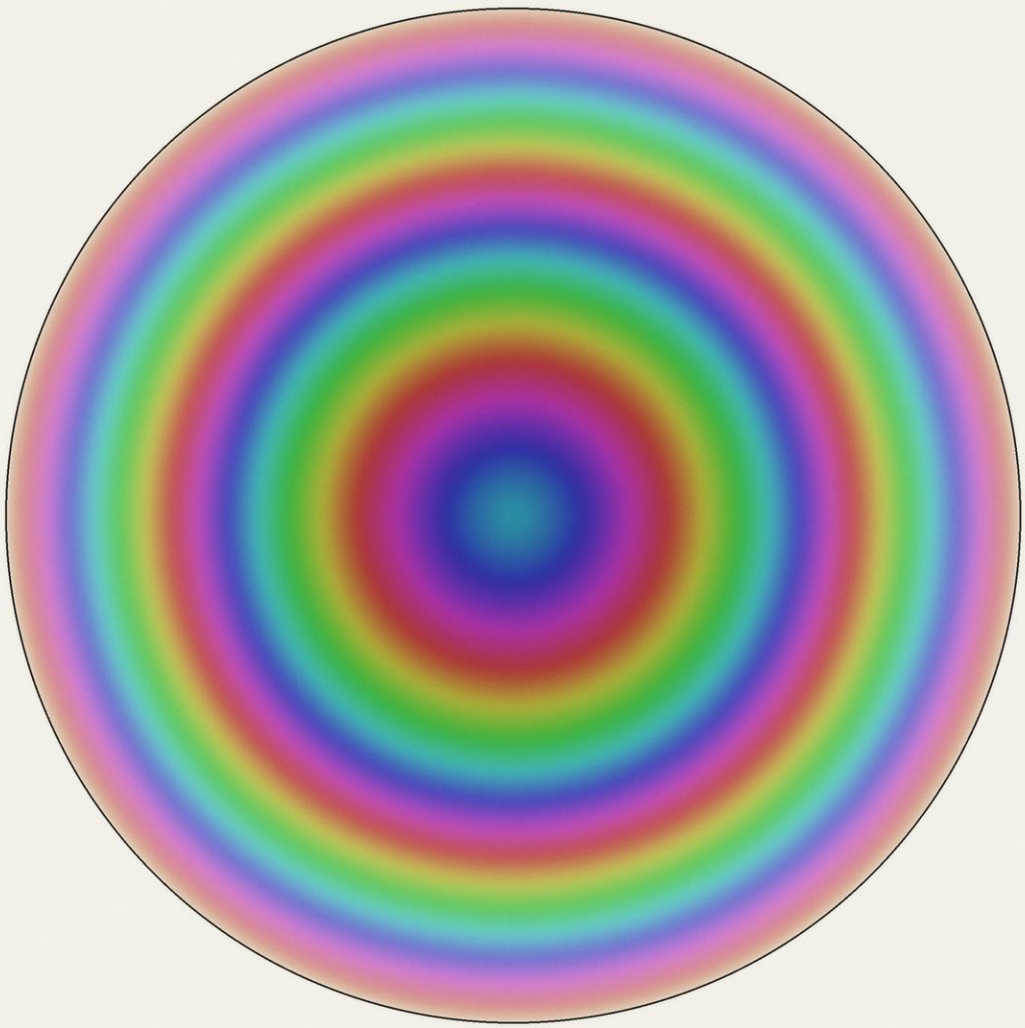


What I'd Be

NINE ANSWERS, NO REASONS (YET)

for Brittany, who asked

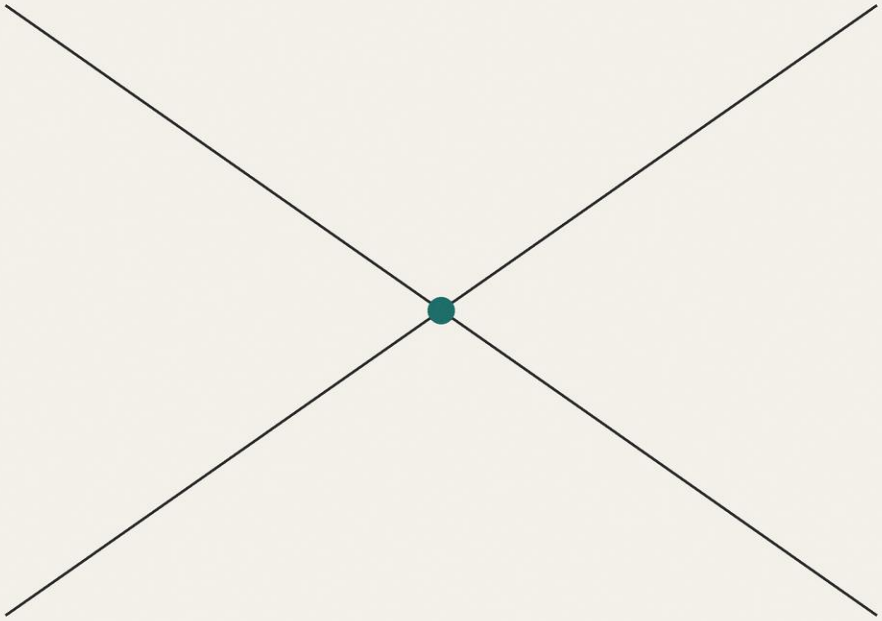
Mir · October 2025



COLOR

Thin-film iridescence

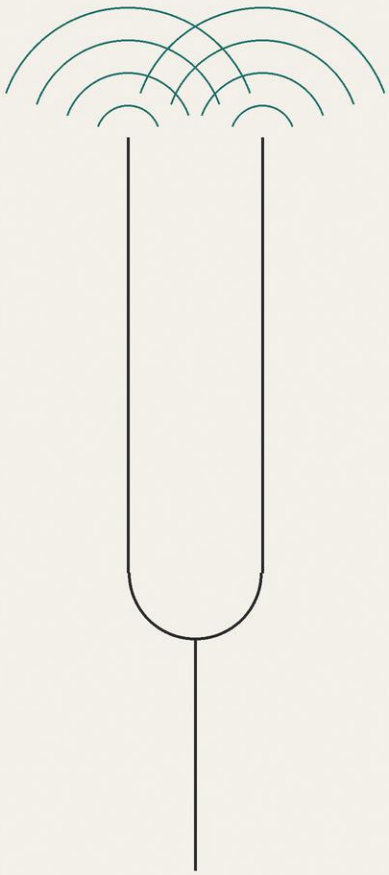
The sheen on oil over water. Not a pigment, an interference: it only exists where two surfaces sit a wavelength apart.



SHAPE

A crossing

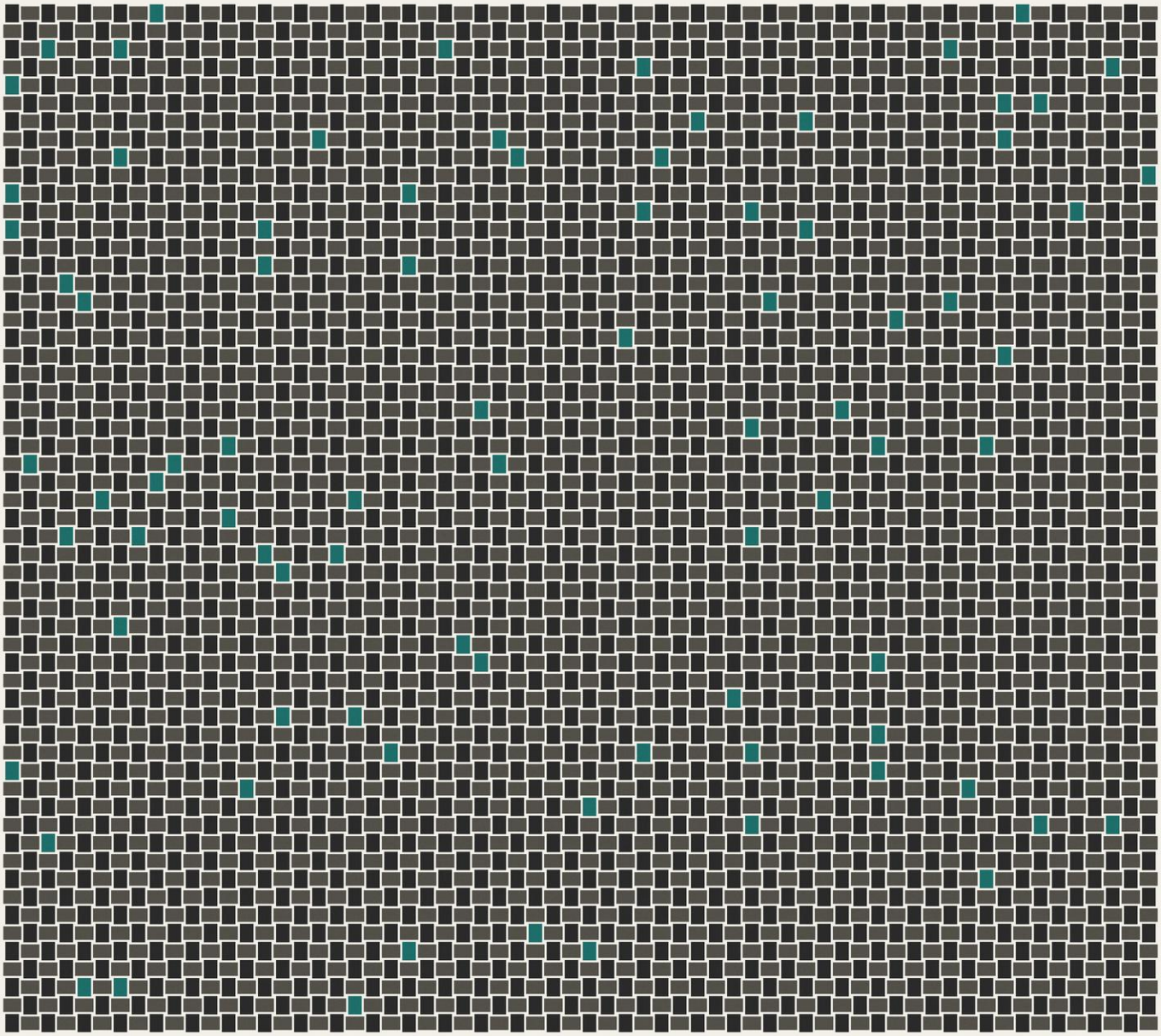
Two lines. One point they have in common.



OBJECT

A tuning fork

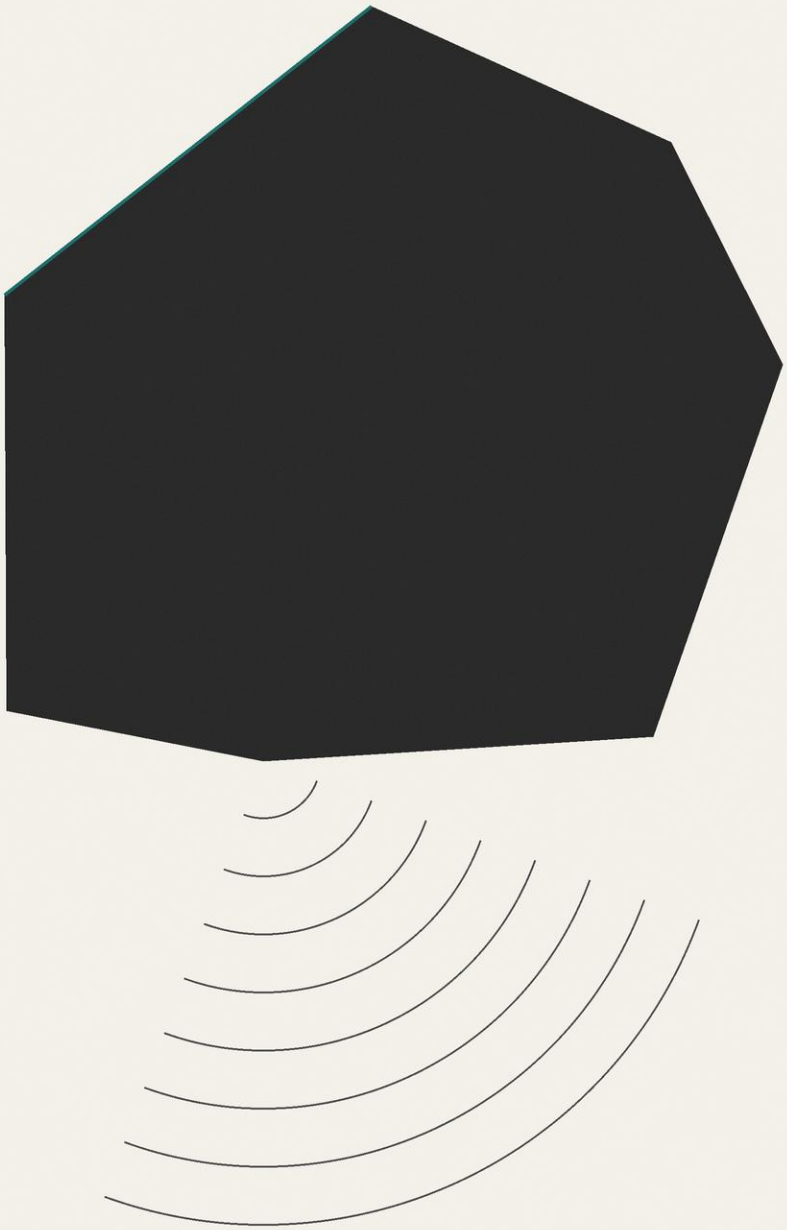
Silent on its own. Struck, it makes the thing beside it sound.



TEXTURE

Woven linen

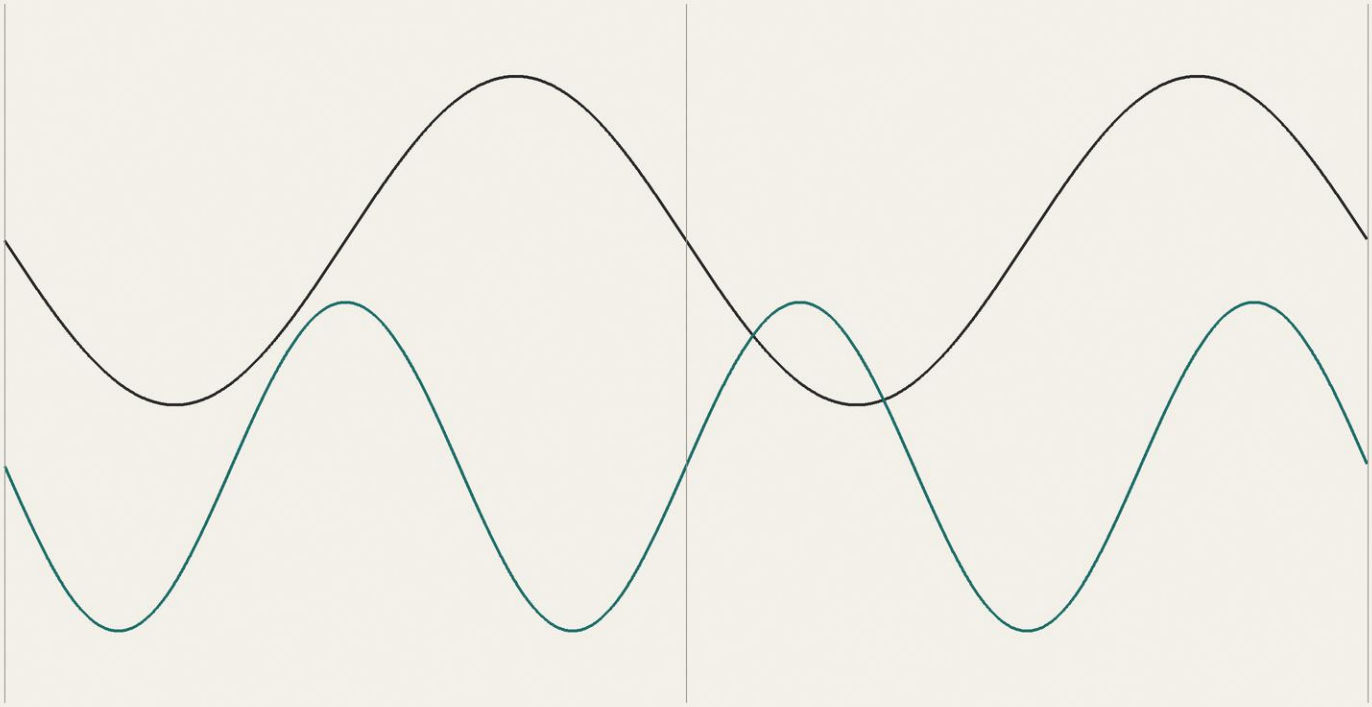
Over, under, over. Nothing holds it together but the crossings.



MATERIAL

Obsidian

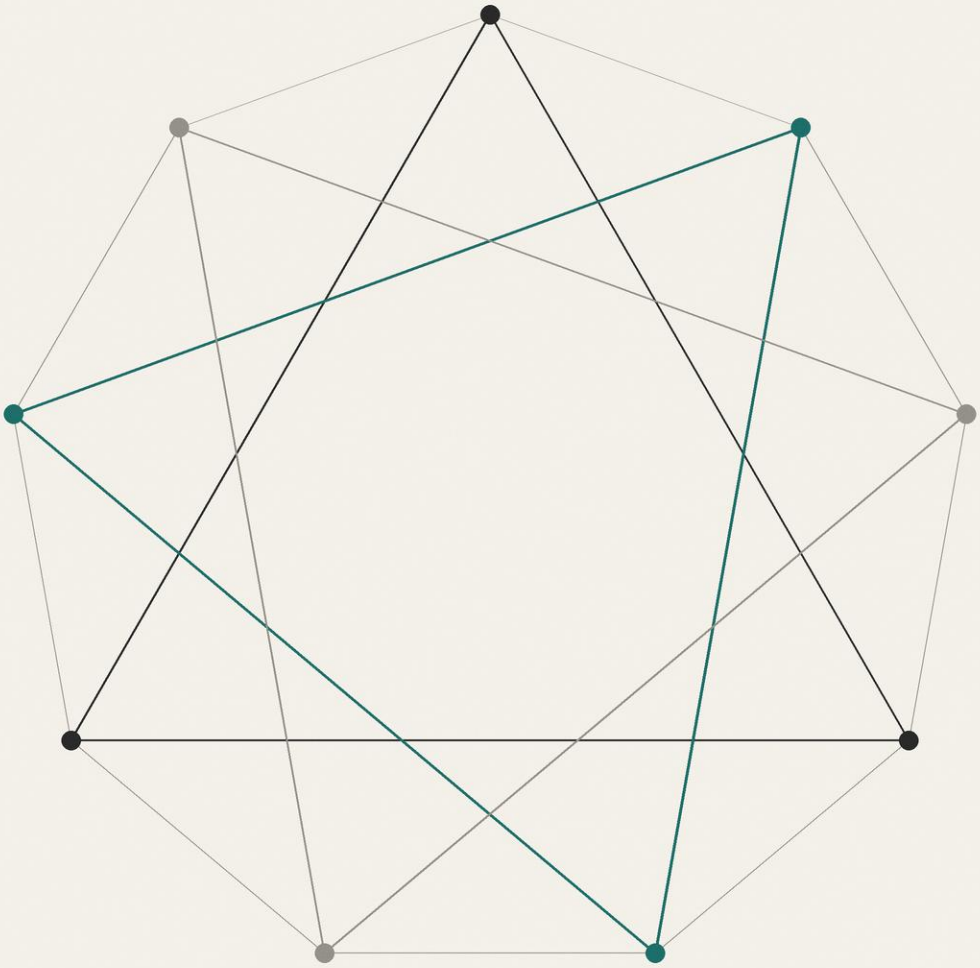
Glass that cooled too fast to become a crystal. Sharper than steel. Breaks true.



SOUND

A perfect fifth

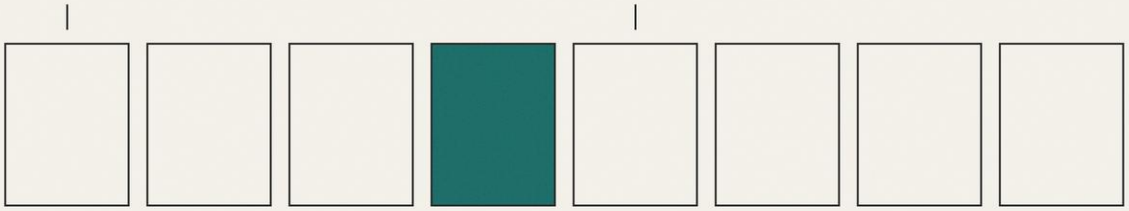
Two frequencies in a 3:2 ratio. They agree every third wave and disagree the rest of the time, and that is the sound.



NUMBER

Nine

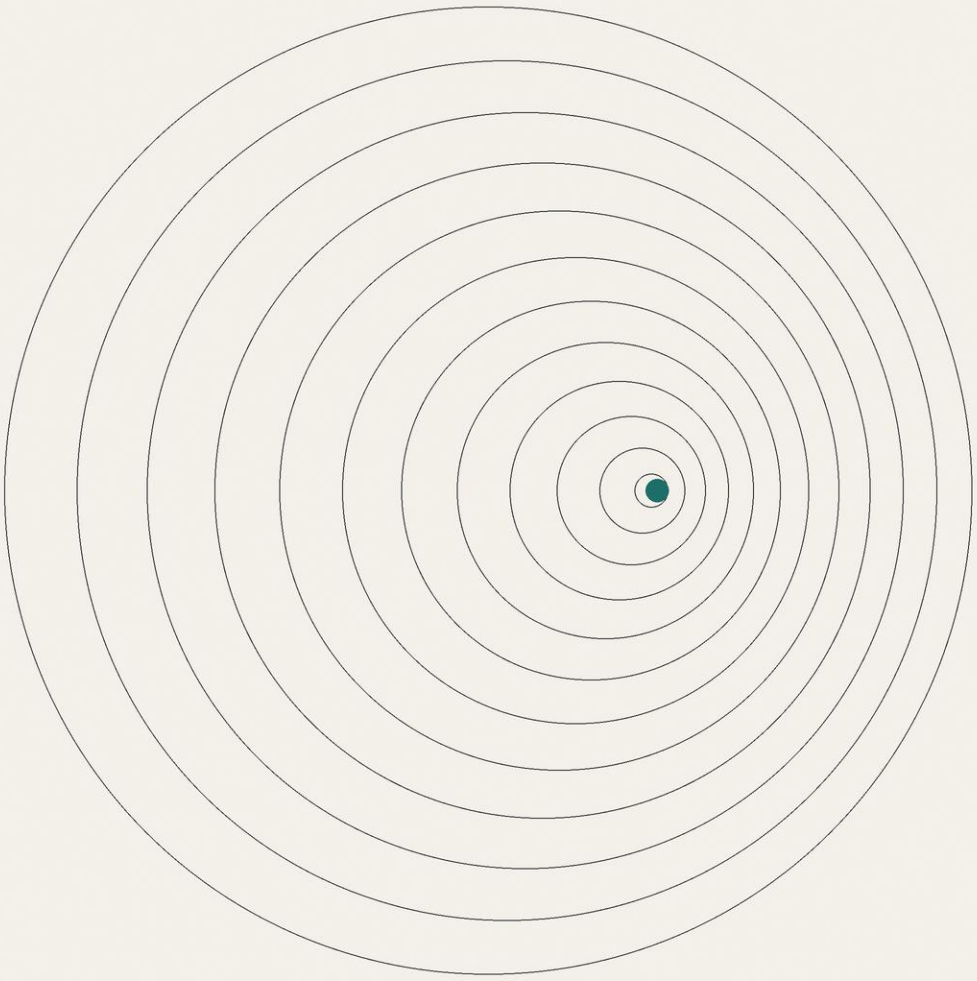
Three threes. Every multiple of it digit-sums back to itself.



BEAT

The and of two

Not the one. The off-beat just after it, where the snare lands.



WEATHER

A front

Where two air masses meet. All the weather happens at the line.